IMY 761 - Deliverable 8 and exam marking

Criterion	Weight	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Weak	Poor
1. Research framing and alignment	8	7–8: Establishes a compelling, well-motivated research problem and gap. Questions are precise and feasible. Methods, findings and discussion consistently address the questions and contribute to answering the primary research question.	6: Clear research problem and relevant questions. The article is generally well aligned, with minor gaps in connections between questions, methods, findings and conclusions.	4–5: Understandable research problem and questions, but rationale or alignment is uneven. Some methods, findings or discussion points are only partially connected to the questions.	2–3: Research problem or questions are poorly motivated, vague or inconsistently addressed. Significant disconnects exist between aims and the research conducted or conclusions drawn.	0–1: No coherent research problem or usable research questions. No meaningful connection between aims, methods, findings and conclusions.

2. Engagement with and integration of literature	13	11–13: Integrates relevant, credible literature throughout the article. Synthesises and critically evaluates research to establish the gap, inform methodological choices and interpret findings. Claims are consistently supported, and the study's contribution is convincingly situated within the field.	9–10: Uses relevant literature to motivate the study, support methods and interpret findings. Demonstrates synthesis and critical engagement, although some connections could be developed further.	6–8: Covers the main relevant concepts and sources but relies partly on description. Literature provides a basic foundation, with limited integration into methods, interpretation or implications.	4–5: Literature coverage is superficial, incomplete or poorly synthesised. Important claims are weakly supported, and the relationship between existing research and the study is unclear.	0–3: Relevant literature is largely absent, inappropriate or inaccurately represented. The study lacks a credible scholarly foundation, and claims are largely unsupported.

3. Research design and methodological rigour	13	11–13: Methods are clearly documented, replicable where appropriate, and convincingly justified in relation to the research questions. Sampling, materials, procedures, data handling and analysis are appropriate and transparent. Ethical considerations and methodological trade-offs are addressed, demonstrating understanding of how design choices affect the evidence produced.	9–10: Methods are appropriate, clearly described and reasonably justified. Most decisions align with the research questions, although some details or critical considerations could be strengthened.	6–8: Methods are understandable and adequate, but justification, procedural detail or alignment is uneven. Some methodological decisions or their consequences receive limited consideration.	4–5: Important methodological details or justifications are missing. Significant design weaknesses limit the study's ability to address its questions, and methodological consequences are inadequately considered.	0–3: Methods are absent, incoherent or fundamentally inappropriate. There is insufficient information to understand or evaluate how the evidence was generated.

4. Data analysis and presentation of findings	13	11–13: Analysis is rigorous, appropriate and accurate. Findings are organised around the research questions, supported by relevant evidence and reported using appropriate analytical conventions. Tables, figures, statistics, themes or other outputs are clear and accurate, and interpretations do not overstate the evidence.	9–10: Analysis is appropriate and generally accurate. Findings address the research questions and are presented clearly, with only minor analytical, reporting or interpretive weaknesses.	6–8: Analysis is adequate but relatively basic, uneven or insufficiently explained. Findings are reported, but connections to the research questions or supporting evidence are sometimes weak.	4–5: Analysis or reporting has substantial weaknesses. Findings are incomplete, confusing or poorly connected to the questions, and errors or unsupported interpretations undermine confidence in the results.	0–3: Meaningful analysis is absent or fundamentally flawed. Findings are missing, unreliable or presented in a way that prevents evaluation of the research questions.

5. Discussion, interpretation and implications	18	16–18: Develops a coherent, critical and insightful argument that synthesises findings across the research questions to answer the primary question. Interprets results in relation to literature and theory, considers alternative explanations and unexpected findings, and distinguishes evidence-based conclusions from speculation. Implications follow logically from the findings and demonstrate the study's contribution and significance.	13–15: Clearly interprets and integrates findings to address the primary question. Makes relevant connections to literature and develops plausible implications, although synthesis, alternative explanations or the significance of the contribution could be explored further.	9–12: Offers reasonable discussion and some connection to literature, but is partly descriptive, treats findings in isolation or only partially answers the primary question. Implications are general or not fully substantiated.	5–8: Discussion is fragmented, predominantly descriptive or weakly connected to literature. Findings are not adequately synthesised, interpretations are poorly justified, and implications are vague, overstated or disconnected from the evidence.	0–4: Meaningful interpretation is absent. The discussion does not answer the primary question, engage meaningfully with existing research or establish credible implications.

6. Limitations, future research and conclusion	5	5: Critically identifies important limitations and explains their implications for interpreting findings. Proposes specific, evidence-based future research directions. Concludes by synthesising the main findings and contribution in relation to the original research gap.	4: Identifies relevant limitations, plausible future directions and a clear conclusion, with minor gaps in critical evaluation or synthesis.	3: Acknowledges some limitations and future directions and provides an adequate conclusion, but these are general, insufficiently connected to findings or limited in critical depth.	2: Limitations are superficial or poorly considered, future research suggestions are vague, or the conclusion provides little meaningful synthesis.	0–1: Limitations and future directions are absent or unhelpful, and the conclusion fails to establish what the study found or contributed.

7. Academic writing, structure and referencing	10	9-10: Clear, concise and professional academic writing throughout. The article is logically structured, flows coherently and uses accurate, consistent referencing. Tables, figures, captions and formatting meet scholarly conventions and support understanding.	7-8: Generally clear and well structured, with minor issues in expression, transitions, formatting or referencing that do not substantially impede understanding.	5-6: Understandable overall, but uneven writing, organisation or formatting occasionally impedes clarity. Referencing contains some errors or inconsistencies.	3-4: Frequent problems with clarity, organisation, academic expression or referencing make parts of the article difficult to follow or evaluate.	0–2: Writing and presentation substantially obstruct understanding. Structure is incoherent, or referencing is largely missing or incorrect.
8. Video sketch (submitted separately)	10	8–10: Professional, engaging and self-contained. Clearly communicates the research project's purpose, use and impact. The demonstration is coherent and technically clear, with effective narration and presentation.	7: Effective and coherent video that communicates the project's purpose and functionality. Minor issues in clarity, flow or polish.	5–6: Understandable and relevant, but basic or underdeveloped in its explanation, demonstration or presentation.	3–4: Poorly structured, with weak narration or an unclear demonstration. Important aspects of the project are difficult to understand.	0–2: Missing, non-functional or irrelevant video that fails to communicate the project meaningfully.

9. Critical reflection	10	9-10: Deep, honest and analytical reflection on the research journey. Critically examines decisions, assumptions, challenges and unexpected developments, explaining why they mattered, what was learned and how this will inform future research. Demonstrates meaningful self-awareness and intellectual or methodological growth.	7-8: Thoughtful reflection on research decisions, challenges and learning. Demonstrates critical insight and identifies lessons for future work, although some aspects remain underexplored or insufficiently analysed.	5-6: Describes the research experience and identifies challenges and lessons, but is primarily descriptive. Analysis of assumptions, consequences, personal learning or future changes is limited.	3-4: Superficial or generic reflection, focused mainly on recounting activities and difficulties. Provides little analysis of why experiences mattered or how they influenced future practice.	0–2: Absent, perfunctory or largely unrelated to the student's research process. Demonstrates little evidence of learning, self-awarenes s or critical engagement.
TOTAL	100					

Word limit penalty - up to 5%

- 1% penalty: over the word limit in 1-2 sections
- 2% penalty: over the word limit 3 sections
- 5% penalty: over the word limit in 4 or more sections